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Greetings!

How are you! Hope that you had a prolific year.

This is another busy year for us. What's new :-) We all work very hard on multiple jobs. Every morning, Lisa gets up early to prepare Emily, Jocelyn, and Rosalind for school. She then reports to her company where she works as a part-time *controller*. In the afternoon, she takes kids to after-school activities. When night falls, she has to cook dinner, take bath for kids, teach them homework, and finally tell them stories and tuck them into bed. Ed constantly needs to write research papers and grant proposals. His hard work seems to pay off: he received National Science Foundation faculty award, the most prestigious junior faculty award, this year.

As things seem to fall into places and as we start to feel Santa Barbara home; ironically, we have a sense of loss. Winter is near. The hunters have almost done their work. The will to climb another hill seems fading.

We talked about that we should spend time to better know our kids. They grow up so fast. If Ed continues to miss their piano recitals, their ballet performance, soccer games, etc., Ed would miss out as a partner in their lives. It is perhaps time to slow down. But this may sound a bit strange to you: slowing down could take more resolve than just working hard for the next goal.

Well, since our hard working this year has not made the world more peaceful nor more prosperous, perhaps we should hardly work next year. Perhaps we will enjoy Santa Barbara seashore and our pool more. Perhaps, we can finally take care of the gopher problem on our backyard hill. Perhaps, we could start farming a garden of avocados and zucchini.

Work less, eat more vegies, and exercise frequently! Wishing you a terrific year!!

Sincerely,

Emily, Jocelyn, Rosalind, Lisa, & Ed Chang